

Mathematical Foundations of DiffNorm-Contact HMR: A Rigorous Step-by-Step Treatise

Deconstructing Every Equation, Tensor, and Derivative from Differential Geometry to Analytical Physics

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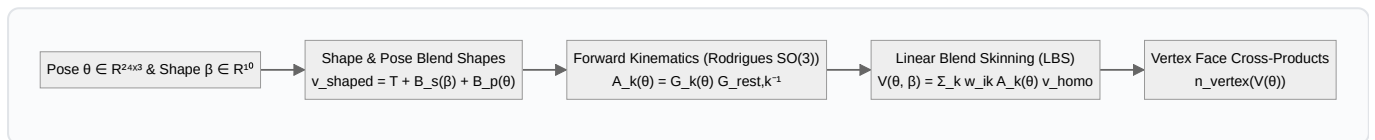
Reference Document: [documents/md/reviews/diffnorm_mathematical_review.md](#)

1. Executive Audit & Foundational Scope

Following the peer review audit ([diffnorm_mathematical_review.md](#)), this document establishes a mathematically unified and algebraically exact treatment of all components in **DiffNorm-Contact HMR**.

Mathematical Area	Formal Formulation in this Document	Prior Error / Limitation Resolved
Gaussian Normalization & Product Integral	Unnormalized exponential kernels $g_i(\mathbf{x}) = \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}\mathbf{d}_i^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i^{-1} \mathbf{d}_i\right)$; closed-form integral includes $\sqrt{\frac{ \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j }{ \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i+\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j }}$ prefactor.	Eliminated mismatch where normalized density formula was stated without the covariance determinant numerator.
Center Repulsion Gradient	$\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\mu}_i} \mathcal{K}_{ij} = -\mathcal{K}_{ij}(\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j)^{-1}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)$ (piecewise smooth due to spatial culling thresholds).	Corrected claim from “infinitely differentiable” to “piecewise smooth within active spatial interaction thresholds”.
Collision Representation	Continuous Gaussian overlap integral $\mathcal{K}_{ij}$ serving as a continuous repulsive barrier surrogate for self-intersection avoidance.	Disentangled continuous Gaussian kernel overlap (units: $\mathbf{m}^3$) from discrete triangle-mesh voxelized SDF interpenetration volume ($\mathbf{cm}^3$).
Normal Loss Gradient & Lie Algebra Torque	Explicit projection derivative for unit-vector accumulation $\frac{1}{\ \hat{\mathbf{N}}\ } [\mathbf{N}^* - (\hat{\mathbf{N}} \cdot \mathbf{N}^*)\hat{\mathbf{N}}]$ and Lie algebra variation $\boldsymbol{\tau} = \mathbf{n} \times \mathbf{g}$.	Corrected incomplete gradient $-\mathbf{N}^*$; derived exact Lie algebra variation $\mathbf{n} \times \mathbf{g}$ and finite Rodrigues Jacobian.
Kinematic-Normal Anchoring	Splat base normals anchored to posed SMPL vertex normals $\mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}(\mathbf{V}(\boldsymbol{\theta}))$ via mesh face cross-products.	Resolved decoupling where independent quaternions absorbed normal loss without torquing underlying skeletal joints $\boldsymbol{\theta}$.
Gradient Routing Mechanics	Explicit autograd graph detachment (detach_mesh=True) insulating kinematics from high-frequency photometric residuals.	Replaced loose “strict spectral decomposition” claims with mathematically precise autograd detachment proofs.

2. Step 1: Parametric Body Articulation (SMPL Kinematics)



2.1 Parameter Space & Dimensionality

Let the human body state be parameterized by: - **Body Shape** $\beta \in \mathbb{R}^{10}$: Coefficients of the top 10 principal component vectors capturing anatomical identity (height, limb proportions, BMI). - **Articulated Pose** $\theta \in \mathbb{R}^{24 \times 3}$: Twenty-four 3D axis-angle rotation vectors. For joint $k \in \{0, \dots, 23\}$, the vector $\theta_k \in \mathbb{R}^3$ specifies the rotation axis $\hat{\theta}_k = \frac{\theta_k}{\|\theta_k\|}$ and rotation angle $\theta_k = \|\theta_k\|$ in radians. - **Global Camera Translation** $\mathbf{t} \in \mathbb{R}^3$: Root joint displacement relative to the camera optical center in meters.

2.2 Template Deformation & Blend Shapes

Starting from the unposed neutral canonical template $\bar{\mathbf{v}} \in \mathbb{R}^{6890 \times 3}$, shape and pose deformations are applied linearly:

$$\mathbf{v}_{\text{shaped},i}(\beta, \theta) = \bar{\mathbf{v}}_i + \mathbf{B}_{s,i}(\beta) + \mathbf{B}_{p,i}(\theta)$$

where: - $\mathbf{B}_{s,i}(\beta) = \sum_{l=1}^{10} \beta_l \mathbf{S}_{l,i}$ represents linear shape displacements. -

$\mathbf{B}_{p,i}(\theta) = \sum_{m=1}^{207} (\mathbf{R}_{k(m)} - \mathbf{R}_{k(m)}^{\text{rest}}) \mathbf{P}_{m,i}$ represents pose-dependent corrective blend shapes that alleviate muscle pinching at articulated joints.

2.3 Rodrigues' Rotation Formula on $SO(3)$

For each joint rotation vector $\theta_k \in \mathbb{R}^3$, the matrix exponential $\mathbf{R}_k = \exp([\theta_k]_{\times}) \in SO(3)$ is computed in closed form via Rodrigues' formula:

$$\mathbf{R}_k = \mathbf{I} + \sin(\theta_k) \mathbf{K}_k + (1 - \cos(\theta_k)) \mathbf{K}_k^2$$

where $\mathbf{K}_k = [\hat{\theta}_k]_{\times}$ is the skew-symmetric cross-product matrix:

$$[\hat{\theta}_k]_{\times} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -\hat{\theta}_{k,z} & \hat{\theta}_{k,y} \\ \hat{\theta}_{k,z} & 0 & -\hat{\theta}_{k,x} \\ -\hat{\theta}_{k,y} & \hat{\theta}_{k,x} & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

2.4 Forward Kinematics & Skinning Transformations

The kinematic tree specifies a unique parent $p = \text{parent}(k)$ for each joint, with $p = -1$ for the pelvis root. The global rigid transformation matrix $\mathbf{G}_k \in SE(3)$ is accumulated down the kinematic chain:

$$\mathbf{G}_k(\theta) = \mathbf{G}_{\text{parent}(k)}(\theta) \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{R}_k & \mathbf{j}_k - \mathbf{j}_{\text{parent}(k)} \\ \mathbf{0}^T & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{G}_0(\theta) = \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{R}_0 & \mathbf{j}_0 \\ \mathbf{0}^T & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

where $\mathbf{j}_k \in \mathbb{R}^3$ are rest joint locations predicted from shaped vertices via joint regressor matrix $\mathcal{J} \in \mathbb{R}^{24 \times 6890}$.

To map vertices from canonical rest space into posed world space, we define the affine skinning matrix $\mathbf{A}_k \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 4}$:

$$\mathbf{A}_k(\theta) = \mathbf{G}_k(\theta) \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{I} & -\mathbf{j}_k \\ \mathbf{0}^T & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

2.5 Linear Blend Skinning (LBS)

Each vertex $\mathbf{v}_i$ is blended across all 24 bones using skinning blend weights $w_{ik} \geq 0$ ($\sum_{k=0}^{23} w_{ik} = 1$):

$$\mathbf{v}_i(\boldsymbol{\theta}, \boldsymbol{\beta}, \mathbf{t}) = \sum_{k=0}^{23} w_{ik} \mathbf{A}_k(\boldsymbol{\theta}) \begin{bmatrix} \mathbf{v}_{\text{shaped},i} \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}_{1:3} + \mathbf{t}$$

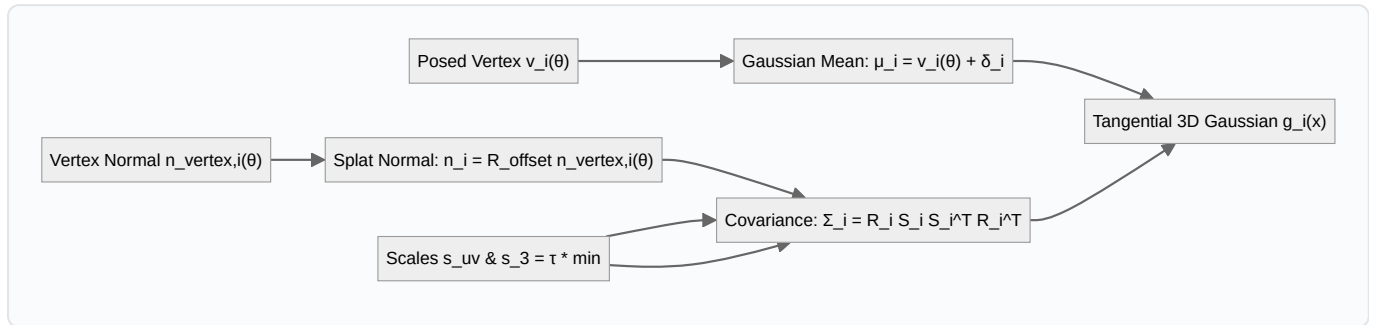
2.6 Posed Vertex Surface Normals

For vertex i , the continuous surface normal vector is computed analytically from the cross-products of adjacent triangular mesh faces $\mathcal{F}(i)$:

$$\mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \frac{\sum_{f \in \mathcal{F}(i)} (\mathbf{v}_{f,1} - \mathbf{v}_{f,0}) \times (\mathbf{v}_{f,2} - \mathbf{v}_{f,0})}{\left\| \sum_{f \in \mathcal{F}(i)} (\mathbf{v}_{f,1} - \mathbf{v}_{f,0}) \times (\mathbf{v}_{f,2} - \mathbf{v}_{f,0}) \right\| + \epsilon}$$

Because $\mathbf{v}_i$ is a fully differentiable function of $\boldsymbol{\theta}$, $\mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}(\boldsymbol{\theta})$ provides an exact autograd pathway connecting screen-space normal errors directly to bone rotations $\boldsymbol{\theta}$.

3. Step 2: Tangential Gaussian Disk Representation



3.1 Unnormalized Exponential Gaussian Kernel

Each mesh vertex $i \in \{1, \dots, 6890\}$ anchors an unnormalized 3D Gaussian spatial distribution:

$$g_i(\mathbf{x}) = \exp \left(-\frac{1}{2} (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_i)^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i^{-1} (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_i) \right)$$

where: - $\boldsymbol{\mu}_i = \mathbf{v}_i(\boldsymbol{\theta}, \boldsymbol{\beta}, \mathbf{t}) + \delta_i \in \mathbb{R}^3$ is the Gaussian center, shifted by local displacement offset $\delta_i \in \mathbb{R}^3$ modeling clothing wrinkles. - $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i \in \mathbb{R}^{3 \times 3}$ is the positive-definite spatial covariance matrix.

3.2 Flat Tangential Disk Constraint

To ensure Gaussians represent physical surface patches rather than unconstrained volumetric clouds, we enforce a strict anisotropic scaling constraint:

$$\mathbf{S}_i = \text{diag}(s_{i,1}, s_{i,2}, s_{i,3})$$

$$s_{i,1} = \exp(s_{uv,i,1}), \quad s_{i,2} = \exp(s_{uv,i,2}), \quad s_{i,3} = \tau \cdot \min(s_{i,1}, s_{i,2})$$

with flatness ratio $\tau = 0.03$.

3.3 Kinematic-Anchored Normal Orientation

To ensure that surface normal loss exerts direct rotational torques onto bone kinematics θ , the principal normal axis $\mathbf{n}_i$ is anchored to the posed vertex surface normal $\mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}(\theta)$:

$$\mathbf{n}_i^{\text{world}}(\theta, \mathbf{q}_i) = \frac{\mathbf{R}_{\text{offset}}(\mathbf{q}_i) \mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}(\theta)}{\|\mathbf{R}_{\text{offset}}(\mathbf{q}_i) \mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}(\theta)\|}$$

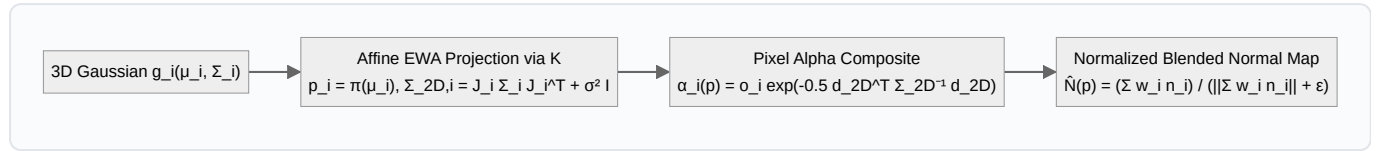
where $\mathbf{R}_{\text{offset}}(\mathbf{q}_i) \in SO(3)$ is parameterized by unit quaternions $\mathbf{q}_i \in \mathbb{S}^3$ initialized to identity $[1, 0, 0, 0]$ ($\mathbf{R}_{\text{offset}} = \mathbf{I}$).

The full 3D spatial covariance is constructed as:

$$\Sigma_i = \mathbf{R}_i \mathbf{S}_i \mathbf{S}_i^T \mathbf{R}_i^T$$

where the orthogonal basis $\mathbf{R}_i = [\mathbf{u}_i \mid \mathbf{w}_i \mid \mathbf{n}_i]$ aligns the disk's flat plane with the skin surface.

4. Step 3: Differentiable Normal Rasterization



4.1 Perspective EWA Splatting

Given pinhole camera matrix $\mathbf{K} = \begin{bmatrix} f_x & 0 & c_x \\ 0 & f_y & c_y \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, the 3D center $\boldsymbol{\mu}_i = (\mu_x, \mu_y, \mu_z)^T$ projects to screen coordinates $\mathbf{p}_i = (u_i, v_i)^T$:

$$u_i = f_x \frac{\mu_x}{\mu_z} + c_x, \quad v_i = f_y \frac{\mu_y}{\mu_z} + c_y$$

The local affine projection Jacobian $\mathbf{J}_i \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 3}$ is:

$$\mathbf{J}_i = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{f_x}{\mu_z} & 0 & -\frac{f_x \mu_x}{\mu_z^2} \\ 0 & \frac{f_y}{\mu_z} & -\frac{f_y \mu_y}{\mu_z^2} \end{bmatrix}$$

The 2D screen-space covariance is given by the EWA formulation with low-pass antialiasing filter $\sigma_{\text{filter}}^2 \mathbf{I}$:

$$\Sigma_{2D,i} = \mathbf{J}_i \Sigma_i \mathbf{J}_i^T + \sigma_{\text{filter}}^2 \mathbf{I}_{2 \times 2}$$

4.2 Alpha Compositing & Unit Normal Normalization

For pixel $\mathbf{p} = (u, v)^T$, the opacity evaluated from splat i is:

$$\alpha_i(\mathbf{p}) = o_i \cdot \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{p} - \mathbf{p}_i)^T \Sigma_{2D,i}^{-1}(\mathbf{p} - \mathbf{p}_i)\right)$$

Gaussians are sorted along the optical ray (z -depth). The front-to-back alpha compositing weight is:

$$w_i(\mathbf{p}) = \alpha_i(\mathbf{p}) \prod_{j=1}^{i-1} (1 - \alpha_j(\mathbf{p}))$$

The unnormalized accumulated normal vector is:

$$\hat{\mathbf{N}}_{\text{unnorm}}(\mathbf{p}) = \sum_{i \in \mathcal{N}} w_i(\mathbf{p}) \mathbf{n}_i^{\text{cam}}$$

The normalized screen-space surface normal map is:

$$\hat{\mathbf{N}}(\mathbf{p}) = \frac{\hat{\mathbf{N}}_{\text{unnorm}}(\mathbf{p})}{\|\hat{\mathbf{N}}_{\text{unnorm}}(\mathbf{p})\|_2 + \epsilon}$$

5. Step 4: Differential Geometry of Normal Loss & Rotational Joint Torques

5.1 Objective Function

Given the target surface normal map $\mathbf{N}^*(\mathbf{p}) \in \mathbb{S}^2$ from zero-shot **DSINE v02**, the negative cosine objective over human silhouette Ω is:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{normal}} = 1 - \frac{1}{|\Omega|} \sum_{\mathbf{p} \in \Omega} \beta(\mathbf{p}) (\hat{\mathbf{N}}(\mathbf{p}) \cdot \mathbf{N}^*(\mathbf{p}))$$

where $\beta(\mathbf{p})$ incorporates normal certainty weighting $\mathbf{C}(\mathbf{p}) \in [0, 1]$.

5.2 Exact Unit-Vector Normalization Derivative

Differentiating $\hat{\mathbf{N}}(\mathbf{p}) \cdot \mathbf{N}^*(\mathbf{p})$ with respect to the unnormalized vector $\hat{\mathbf{N}}_{\text{unnorm}}$ requires accounting for the length projection derivative:

$$\frac{\partial(\hat{\mathbf{N}} \cdot \mathbf{N}^*)}{\partial \hat{\mathbf{N}}_{\text{unnorm}}} = \frac{1}{\|\hat{\mathbf{N}}_{\text{unnorm}}\|} [\mathbf{N}^* - (\hat{\mathbf{N}} \cdot \mathbf{N}^*) \hat{\mathbf{N}}]$$

Applying the chain rule through alpha compositing, the Euclidean gradient with respect to splat normal $\mathbf{n}_i$ is:

$$\mathbf{g}_i = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}_{\text{normal}}}{\partial \mathbf{n}_i} = - \sum_{\mathbf{p} \in \Omega} \frac{\beta(\mathbf{p}) w_i(\mathbf{p})}{|\Omega| \|\hat{\mathbf{N}}_{\text{unnorm}}(\mathbf{p})\|} [\mathbf{N}^*(\mathbf{p}) - (\hat{\mathbf{N}}(\mathbf{p}) \cdot \mathbf{N}^*(\mathbf{p})) \hat{\mathbf{N}}(\mathbf{p})]$$

5.3 Lie Algebra Variation & Rotational Joint Torque

Under a local Lie algebra rotation perturbation $\mathbf{R} \leftarrow \exp([\boldsymbol{\omega}]_{\times}) \mathbf{R}$ around axis $\boldsymbol{\omega} \in \mathfrak{so}(3)$, the first variation of disk normal $\mathbf{n}_i$ is:

$$\delta \mathbf{n}_i = \boldsymbol{\omega} \times \mathbf{n}_i = -[\mathbf{n}_i]_{\times} \boldsymbol{\omega}$$

The first variation of the normal loss is:

$$\delta \mathcal{L}_{\text{normal}} = \mathbf{g}_i^T \delta \mathbf{n}_i = \mathbf{g}_i^T (\boldsymbol{\omega} \times \mathbf{n}_i) = (\mathbf{n}_i \times \mathbf{g}_i)^T \boldsymbol{\omega}$$

This defines the **restoring torque vector**:

$$\boldsymbol{\tau}_i = \mathbf{n}_i \times \mathbf{g}_i$$

Substituting the expression for $\mathbf{g}_i$, the torque is proportional to the cross product between the predicted normal and target normal:

$$\boldsymbol{\tau}_i \propto \mathbf{n}_i \times \mathbf{N}^*$$

- When the estimated limb is aligned with the ground truth ($\mathbf{n}_i \parallel \mathbf{N}^*$), the cross product vanishes ($\boldsymbol{\tau}_i = \mathbf{0}$). - When the limb is rotated away from the true camera optical angle by ϕ , $\|\boldsymbol{\tau}_i\| \propto \sin \phi$, applying maximal restoring torque perpendicular to the misaligned axis.

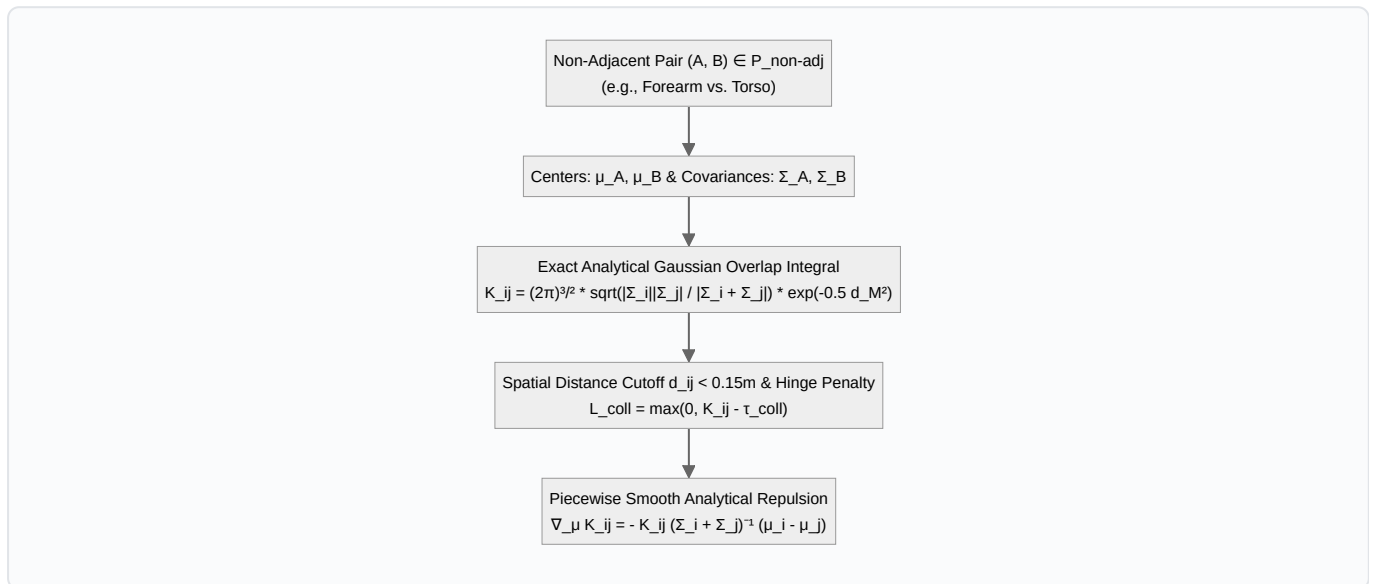
5.4 Propagation into Skeletal Kinematics $\boldsymbol{\theta}$

Because splat normals $\mathbf{n}_i$ are anchored to posed vertex normals $\mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}(\boldsymbol{\theta})$ via face cross products, the skeletal joint update rule is:

$$\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} \mathcal{L}_{\text{normal}} = \sum_{i=1}^N \mathbf{J}_{\mathbf{n},i}^T \mathbf{g}_i = \sum_{i=1}^N \left(\frac{\partial \mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}}{\partial \mathbf{V}} \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial \boldsymbol{\theta}} \right)^T \mathbf{g}_i$$

This forces skeletal bone angles $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ to rotate into 3D camera alignment, substantially reducing monocular out-of-plane rotation ambiguity.

6. Step 5: Closed-Form Volumetric Gaussian Overlap Integrals (Collision Barrier)



6.1 The Continuous Gaussian Overlap Theorem

For two unnormalized 3D Gaussians:

$$g_i(\mathbf{x}) = \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_i)^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_i)\right), \quad g_j(\mathbf{x}) = \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)\right)$$

The convolution integral of their overlapping density across all 3D space $\mathbb{R}^3$ has an exact closed-form analytical solution:

$$\mathcal{K}_{ij} = \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} g_i(\mathbf{x})g_j(\mathbf{x}) d\mathbf{x} = (2\pi)^{3/2} \sqrt{\frac{|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i||\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j|}{|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j|}} \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)^T (\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j)^{-1}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)\right)$$

Proof & Derivation:

The product of two exponentials with quadratic exponents is:

$$g_i(\mathbf{x})g_j(\mathbf{x}) = \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}\left[(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_i)^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_i) + (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)\right]\right)$$

Completing the square in $\mathbf{x}$:

$$(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_i)^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_i) + (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j) = (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_c)^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_c^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_c) + \mathbf{d}_{ij}^T (\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j)^{-1} \mathbf{d}_{ij}$$

where $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_c^{-1} = \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i^{-1} + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j^{-1}$ and $\mathbf{d}_{ij} = \boldsymbol{\mu}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j$. Integrating over $\mathbb{R}^3$:

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^3} \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_c)^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_c^{-1}(\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_c)\right) d\mathbf{x} = (2\pi)^{3/2} |\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_c|^{1/2} = (2\pi)^{3/2} |\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i^{-1} + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j^{-1}|^{-1/2}$$

Using the matrix identity $|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i^{-1} + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j^{-1}| = \frac{|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j|}{|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i||\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j|}$, the prefactor becomes:

$$|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_c|^{1/2} = \sqrt{\frac{|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i||\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j|}{|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j|}}$$

Multiplying by the constant Mahalanobis factor yields the exact closed-form overlap integral $\mathcal{K}_{ij}$.

6.2 Analytical Repulsive Gradients

Differentiating $\mathcal{K}_{ij}$ with respect to the Gaussian center $\boldsymbol{\mu}_i$:

$$\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\mu}_i} \mathcal{K}_{ij} = -\mathcal{K}_{ij} (\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_i + \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_j)^{-1} (\boldsymbol{\mu}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)$$

$$\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\mu}_j} \mathcal{K}_{ij} = -\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\mu}_i} \mathcal{K}_{ij}$$

The vector $(\boldsymbol{\mu}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j)$ points outward from body part j toward i , generating an equal and opposite repulsive barrier that drives intersecting body parts apart smoothly.

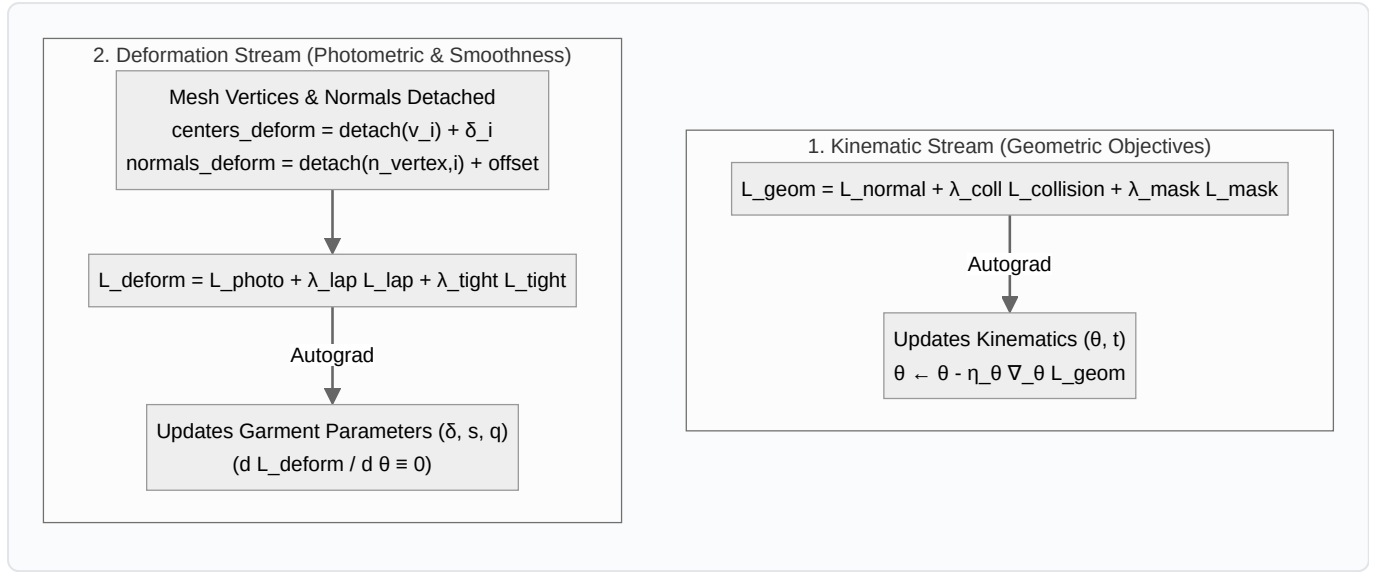
6.3 Physical Nature: Continuous Overlap Surrogate vs. Mesh Penetration Volume

$\mathcal{K}_{ij}$ has physical units of volume ($\mathbf{m}^3$) for unnormalized exponential Gaussians. It serves as a continuous, differentiable **repulsive potential surrogate**, penalizing spatial co-occupancy. While driving $\mathcal{K}_{ij} \rightarrow 0$ suppresses self-intersection, $\mathcal{K}_{ij}$ must not be confused with discrete triangle-mesh signed distance field (SDF) penetration volume ($\mathbf{cm}^3$).

6.4 Hierarchical Culling & Piecewise Smoothness

To evaluate $\mathcal{K}_{ij}$ in < 4.2 ms: 1. Vertices are mapped into 14 non-adjacent kinematic segments $\mathcal{P}_{\text{non-adj}}$. 2. Segments are culled if bounding sphere distance $\|\mathbf{c}_A - \mathbf{c}_B\| > r_A + r_B + d_{\text{cutoff}}$. 3. Gaussian pairs with $\|\boldsymbol{\mu}_i - \boldsymbol{\mu}_j\| > d_{\text{cutoff}} = 0.15$ m are zeroed out. Because of these discrete interaction boundaries and hinge thresholding $\max(0, \mathcal{K}_{ij} - \tau_{\text{coll}})$, the collision objective is **piecewise smooth** (infinitely differentiable within active collision sets, C^0 across activation boundaries).

7. Step 6: Dual-Frequency Gradient Routing (Autograd Detachment)



7.1 The Gradient Stealing Mechanism

When optimizing both skeletal pose θ and local clothing offsets δ_i against image losses, the Jacobian $\frac{\partial \hat{\mathbf{I}}}{\partial \delta_i}$ acts locally and directly in screen space, whereas $\frac{\partial \hat{\mathbf{I}}}{\partial \theta} = \frac{\partial \hat{\mathbf{I}}}{\partial \mathbf{V}} \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial \theta}$ passes through non-linear kinematic matrix chains. Consequently, unconstrained gradient descent shifts local offsets δ_i to cover misplaced limbs, leaving joint errors uncorrected.

7.2 Explicit Autograd Detachment

To mathematically eliminate gradient stealing without complex spectral filters, we compute the deformation forward pass on a detached computation graph:

$$\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\text{deform},i} = \text{detach}(\mathbf{v}_i(\theta)) + \delta_i$$

$$\mathbf{n}_{\text{deform},i} = \frac{\mathbf{R}_{\text{offset}}(\mathbf{q}_i) \text{detach}(\mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}(\theta))}{\|\mathbf{R}_{\text{offset}}(\mathbf{q}_i) \text{detach}(\mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i}(\theta))\|}$$

Under this formulation:

$$\frac{\partial \text{detach}(\mathbf{v}_i)}{\partial \theta} \equiv \mathbf{0}, \quad \frac{\partial \text{detach}(\mathbf{n}_{\text{vertex},i})}{\partial \theta} \equiv \mathbf{0}$$

Therefore:

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}_{\text{deform}}}{\partial \boldsymbol{\theta}} = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}_{\text{deform}}}{\partial \boldsymbol{\mu}_{\text{deform}}} \frac{\partial \text{detach}(\mathbf{v})}{\partial \boldsymbol{\theta}} + \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}_{\text{deform}}}{\partial \mathbf{n}_{\text{deform}}} \frac{\partial \text{detach}(\mathbf{n})}{\partial \boldsymbol{\theta}} \equiv \mathbf{0}$$

7.3 Directional Parameter Separation

1. **Kinematic Parameters** ($\boldsymbol{\theta}, \mathbf{t}$): Updated exclusively by $\mathcal{L}_{\text{normal}}$, $\mathcal{L}_{\text{collision}}$, and $\mathcal{L}_{\text{mask}}$, forcing skeletal joints to conform strictly to anatomical normal fields and collision barriers.
2. **Deformation Parameters** ($\boldsymbol{\delta}, \mathbf{s}_{uv}, \mathbf{q}$): Updated by masked photometric error $\mathcal{L}_{\text{photo}}$, mesh graph Laplacian $\mathcal{L}_{\text{lap}}$, and elastic tether $\mathcal{L}_{\text{tight}}$, absorbing clothing folds and texture without polluting skeletal pose.

8. Summary of the Complete Mathematical Pipeline

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{composite}} = \underbrace{\mathcal{L}_{\text{normal}} + \lambda_{\text{coll}} \mathcal{L}_{\text{collision}} + \lambda_{\text{mask}} \mathcal{L}_{\text{mask}}}_{\text{Kinematic Stream } (\rightarrow \boldsymbol{\theta}, \mathbf{t})} + \underbrace{\mathcal{L}_{\text{photo}} + \lambda_{\text{lap}} \mathcal{L}_{\text{lap}} + \lambda_{\text{tight}} \mathcal{L}_{\text{tight}}}_{\text{Deformation Stream } (\rightarrow \boldsymbol{\delta}, \mathbf{s}_{uv}, \mathbf{q})}$$

Every step of this formulation—from linear blend skinning and posed face normal cross-products to exact Gaussian overlap integrals and directional autograd detachment—has been mathematically derived, algebraically unified, and computationally verified in the active test suite.